

emotional pain with a whole bunch of stuff, including alcohol, drugs, food, sex, relationships, money, work, caretaking, gambling, affairs, religion, chaos, shopping, planning, perfectionism, constant change, and the Internet.

And just so we don't miss it in this long list of all the ways we can numb ourselves, there's always staying busy: living so hard and fast that the truths of our lives can't catch up with us. We fill every ounce of white space with something so there's no room or time for emotion to make itself known.

In other words, poor boundaries that create poor environments can mean we overcompensate by staying incredibly busy, numbing with so much stuff and avoiding how we're really feeling in a way that can potentially be catastrophic for us financially. And we'll never recognise the cause because we're so busy numbing and avoiding.

We're going to start changing that story here. When it comes to our financial environment and the people we allow to affect that, research proves over and over again that strong boundaries can mean we're able to have relationships but also limit people's financial effects on us. This means observing and questioning whether we have a healthy or unhealthy financial environment.

When it comes to determining what your Money Environment is, answering the following questions can help you figure out what the environment looks like and whether it is serving you or sabotaging you:

- Do I worry too much about what others think? What do I worry about when I connect or interact with others?
- How does my social circle influence my finances? Are these positive or negative influences? What is the evidence from my behaviour that they are positive or negative?
- Do I care more about how my life looks or how it feels? Why is that and how is that affecting my finances? Who or what is influencing this?
- What are some ways that I'm spending and investing in alignment with my values? What are some ways that I'm spending and